

Final Essay: *102 Voices on Community*

Each week in this course, you will gather ideas, reflect, and share discoveries to shape your final essay. Learning new Habits of Mind and other major concepts to help you think more deeply will help you grow as thinkers and writers. Through journals and discussion conversations with classmates—your Community of Writers—you'll refine your critical thinking and writing. You will receive weekly feedback from your instructor and gather ideas and writing techniques from Mentor Texts to help you craft your best work for *102 Voices on Community*.

Subject: Your essay should address a specific community to which you belong, and it should propose a strategy to make that community more socially connected. You might choose to build on something already in place, restore something that was lost, remove obstacles for growth, or explore new opportunities to improve community connection.

Occasion: Each of you will contribute your essay to a class collection called *102 Voices on Community* to showcase your work. At the end of the term, your instructor will collect and share the collection within your course for the class to enjoy.

Audience: The audience of your essay is leaders and members of your chosen community. Titles should identify the specific group, such as:

- *102 Voices on Community: Building a Stronger Neighborhood*
- *102 Voices on Community: Building a Stronger Workplace*
- *102 Voices on Community: Building a Stronger Bellevue University*

Purpose: The purpose of this essay is to propose an effective, realistic strategy that will foster connection within your specific community.

Guidelines:

- Minimum 1000 words
- Provide:
 - o Evidence that change is needed
 - o Reasons your approach is effective compared to alternatives
 - o Recognition of challenges/limitations
- Incorporate at least three of the Mentor Texts from class (found below), two outside sources that you research, and your own personal experience.
- Cite all references properly.
- Submit as a Word document with title, name, course, and section.

Mentor Texts:

Hampton, K., Wellman, B. (2018). *Lost and saved . . . again: The moral panic about the loss of community takes hold of social media*. American Sociological Association. Retrieved from <https://www.asanet.org/wp-content/uploads/attach/journals/nov18csfeature.pdf>

Khan, A. (2019, Dec. 26). *The loss of community: The existential threat*. Medium. Retrieved from [https://urldefense.com/v3/https://adityakhan.medium.com/the-loss-of-community-an-existential-threat-d1677bb9f573_!!NmoQVLtQOg!De1PIEnEf7c1j7ZqQfOWYlgdyxf8fdNGiN9Bw8R9_xm5-uoU5LKVxy3vd2kHVQGx4-QjxH6TNjwx-BRr_Oy18eY\\$](https://urldefense.com/v3/https://adityakhan.medium.com/the-loss-of-community-an-existential-threat-d1677bb9f573_!!NmoQVLtQOg!De1PIEnEf7c1j7ZqQfOWYlgdyxf8fdNGiN9Bw8R9_xm5-uoU5LKVxy3vd2kHVQGx4-QjxH6TNjwx-BRr_Oy18eY$)

Lowe, T. (2021, Feb.24). *What is 'community' and why is it important?* Medium. Retrieved from <https://medium.com/centre-for-public-impact/what-is-community-2e895219a205>

U.S. Surgeon General's Office, (2023). *Our epidemic of loneliness and isolation*. The U.S. Surgeon General's Advisory on the Healing Effects of Social Connection and Community. <https://www.hhs.gov/sites/default/files/surgeon-general-social-connection-advisory.pdf>

Volpe, A. (2022, Mar. 24). *Why community matters so much-and how to find yours*. Vox. Retrieved from <https://www.vox.com/22992901/how-to-find-your-community-as-an-adult>

Zubernis, L. (2023, Mar. 28). *Can social media and online communities be good for us?* Psychology Today. Retrieved from <https://www.psychologytoday.com/us/blog/the-science-of-fandom/202303/can-social-media-and-online-communities-be-good-for-us>

Process:

- Gather Ideas
- Prewrite and Think
- Discuss / Feedback on Initial Thoughts
- Prewrite and Plan
- Create First Draft
- Discuss / Feedback on First Draft
- Revise
- Create Final Draft
- Publish in *102 Voices on Community* for class distribution only

Next Step: After you submit your essay to our class publication in Week 9, you'll complete the Final Assignment - Journey of Improvement in Week 10, which documents your progress throughout the course.